Israelis get their news from the *Bibiton*, or from *Yediot*. The latter is critical of Netanyahu, but on other issues it takes a nationalist, jingoistic tone that is often indistinguishable from *Israel HaYom*. The same goes for Channel 2, which is hardly known for its crusading investigative journalism. Their military correspondent, Roni Daniel, is sometimes jokingly called the "IDF spokesman" because he hews so closely to the official line. During the 2006 Lebanon war he angrily asked a real army spokesman why they weren't dropping more bombs on Beirut. He also dismissed a video of two Palestinian teenagers shot during a May 2014 protest as a fake, a claim that was swiftly disproved. (A year after the third Gaza war, he made an impassioned call for Israel to "change its policy" and lift the blockade of the strip; a local NGO worker forwarded me the clip, calling it the clearest sign yet that the army was unhappy with Netanyahu's position on Gaza.)

For a foreign journalist, Israel is one of the most accessible countries in the Middle East. It is also the most heavily scrutinized, with pro-Israel groups like CAMERA that pore over every word written about the conflict. The pressure has grown in recent years, partly due to the advent of social media. Michael Oren once suggested that Israel's advocates engage in online "shaming" of journalists—which, I can assure him, they need little encouragement to do.

In February 2016, a Knesset subcommittee called a hearing to discuss unfair media coverage of Israel. It was convened because of a headline published on CBS a week earlier, after three Palestinians armed with guns, knives, and explosives tried to carry out a serious attack in East Jerusalem. Two Israeli policewomen foiled the plot by killing the attackers. Both officers were hurt, and one, Hadar Cohen, died of her wounds that evening. The poorly-worded headline on the CBS website, though, was "Three Palestinians killed as daily violence grinds on". The foreign ministry spokesman immediately sent a screen grab of the headline to journalists, calling it "unprecedented chutzpah". The image rocketed around social media, with Tzipi Livni, a former foreign minister, accusing the network of "choosing sides". Nitzan Chen, the head of the government press office, wrote on Facebook that he would consider revoking press credentials from outlets that published such headlines.

At the hearing, lawmakers asked Chen to provide other examples of media bias. He cited three other headlines from CBS, CNN, and the BBC. That was the extent of his presentation: four faulty headlines, out of